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THE NATION | MADHYA PRADESH

IN TROUBLED LANDS

ALLEGATIONS OVER HIS FAMILY'S GROWING LAND HOLDING THREATEN TO DERAIL THE EQUITY MOHAN YADAV HAS PAINSTAKINGLY BUILT IN HIS CHIEF MINISTERIAL TENURE SO FAR

By RAHUL NORONHA

June 23 began like any other Tuesday for Madhya Pradesh chief minister Mohan Yadav. The day is reserved for the weekly cabinet meeting at the Mantralaya in Bhopal, and officials at the CM's residence on the Shyamla Hills were finalising the day's agenda when one of Yadav's trusted political aides called an assistant's phone.

"I got a call from a central BJP leader in Delhi," the aide told Yadav. "He forwarded a report published in today's *Indian Express*. It is about land ownership involving you and your family in and around Ujjain." Yadav took a longish pause to process the information before hanging up.

Within hours, the report had triggered the biggest political challenge of Yadav's tenure. For more than two and a half years after taking office in December 2023, the CM had largely escaped sustained political attacks. The report revealed